> *I am fundamentally an optimist. Whether that comes from nature or nurture, I cannot say. Part of being optimistic is keeping one's head pointed toward the sun, one's feet moving forward. There were dark moments when my faith in humanity was sorely tested, but I would not and could not give myself up to despair.*

Isn't that the key? Isn't that what we must all do? Can we keep our heads pointed towards the sun and keep our feet moving forward, and never give ourselves up to despair?

He also wrote:

> *I always knew that deep down in every human heart, there is mercy and generosity. No one is born hating another person because of the colour of his skin, or his background, or his religion. People must learn to hate, and if they can learn to hate, they can be taught to love, for love comes more naturally to the human heart than its opposite. Even in the grimmest times in prison, when my comrades and I were pushed to our limits, I would see a glimmer of humanity in one of the guards, perhaps just for a second, but it was enough to reassure me and keep me going. Man's goodness is a flame that can be hidden but never extinguished.*

Even in the grimmest of times, as South Africans, we can cling to the truth that, deep down, the overwhelming majority of 53 million citizens are fundamentally good people who desperately want this 'rainbow nation' to prosper and succeed, to settle into stability, and that, eventually, this collective desire will prevail.

If it is the *gees* and the spirit of the people that motivates and inspires me, it is the sight and feel of the land that sustains and